

GHOST EMPLOYEE / TERMINATED APPROVER CONTROL SOP

Standard Operating Procedure | SOP No. SOP-GEC-009 | Version 1.0

SOP Number:	SOP-GEC-009
Version:	1.0
Effective Date:	September 10, 2025
Process Owner:	Meagan Barry (EMP-2380) — Deputy Manager
Applicable System(s):	Audit Assistant Platform / ERP / Finance System

1. PURPOSE

This SOP defines the standardised process for ghost employee / terminated approver control to ensure consistency, control effectiveness, and audit traceability across all business units.

2. PROCESS FLOW

- Step 1:** HR system updates employment_status to TERMINATED upon offboarding
- Step 2:** System access deprovisioning triggered within 24 hours of termination
- Step 3:** Approval system blocks transactions from terminated employee_id
- Step 4:** Monthly reconciliation cross-checks Approval_Workflow against HR status
- Step 5:** Any post-termination approvals are escalated as FRAUD_PATTERN findings

3. ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

Role	Responsibility
Risk Analyst	Initiates and validates process inputs
Internal Auditor	Monitors exceptions and escalates as required
Compliance Officer	Initiates and validates process inputs
Procurement Analyst	Performs periodic reconciliation and reporting

4. CONTROLS

This process incorporates the following key controls: (i) system-enforced validation against the Delegation of Authority Policy; (ii) mandatory documentation attachment prior to approval; (iii) periodic exception reporting to Internal Audit; and (iv) quarterly process effectiveness review.

5. EXCEPTION HANDLING

Any deviation from this SOP must be documented with justification and approved by Deputy Manager or delegate. Exceptions are logged in the exception register and reviewed monthly by the Risk Committee. Repeated exceptions of the same type will trigger a process redesign review.

6. RELATED DOCUMENTS

This SOP should be read in conjunction with the Delegation of Authority Policy, the Internal Audit Charter, and the relevant functional policy governing this process area.